EZEH IKENNA

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Professional Summary

AI native operations professional with 10+ years of hands-on operations experience across retail, banking, and B2B services. Over the past three years, I have built AI and automation systems that address root causes rather than symptoms. I set up evaluation and observability before a system reaches live users, using LangSmith and I build day to day with Claude Code and Codex. I am skilled at system design, automation, clear communication with cross-functional teams, and handling customer information end to end. I also have a habit of learning fast. As an independent founder, I learned that in a competitive market, services can make or break a business, so I treat every customer as an MVC. Seeking roles focused on making operations run cleaner, spotting the friction points other people have stopped noticing, and building whatever removes them, with AI agents as the baseline.

Professional Experience

Co-founder, Rithma Labs (Global AI & Systems Consulting) *Sept 2024 – Present*

- Launched an AI triage layer for a high-growth neobank's mobile app, connecting chat to n8n, Zendesk, and Slack. It resolves routine queries automatically, turns complex issues into context-rich Zendesk tickets, and sends real-time Slack alerts for high-priority escalations.
- Deployed an automated churn-prediction and re-engagement pipeline for an e-commerce brand, triggered by purchase dormancy. Sends targeted WhatsApp and email sequences that cut 60-day churn by 33% and recovered over ₦17M in dormant customer value.
- Built a centralized legal knowledge engine for a full-service law firm with clause-level citations across case law, SOPs, and regulations. Uses hybrid vector retrieval and role-based access control to protect client-attorney privilege, cutting associate research time by 55%.
- Delivered a technical integration blueprint for an energy-sector multinational, mapping data pipelines across enterprise systems (SAP ERP, SLB Lumi, Avocet) and field OT systems (AVEVA PI, SCADA) to lay the foundation for a later AI rollout

Operations Systems Partner - Standard Chartered Bank *Aug 2021 – Dec 2024*

- Monitored the bank's real-time customer engagement pipelines via SAP ERP and Jira Service Management, flagging operational exceptions and coordinating escalation workflows with cross-functional teams under strict SLAs.
- Partnered with data science teams to deploy an AI credit-scoring model, utilizing Power BI dashboards to monitor Python model default-risk outputs and support credit risk acceptance decisions.
- Collaborated with compliance and engineering teams to roll out a digital KYC verification platform using REST APIs and SQL query pipelines aligned with Central Bank of Nigeria requirements.
- Built and managed cross-functional workflow tracking systems in Jira and QuickBooks, optimizing resource allocation and project throughput across core financial operations.

** Adapts fast across operations and technical tooling, picking up new systems and platforms as quickly as the AI industry changes.*

Co-Founder & Chief Operating Officer (COO) | Ropa Brand *Feb 2014 – Mar 2021*

- Founded and scaled an independent fashion retail brand from 4 to 35 team members, overseeing daily operations, hiring, and revenue growth
- Managed international vendor relationships across fabric sourcing, garment manufacturing, and custom packaging, supporting over 8,000 customers (retail & bespoke)
- Designed an automated Google Sheets fulfillment system integrated with GIG & FedEx API webhooks to track inventory and manage local courier deliveries across extensive SKUs with 99% accuracy.
- Rolled out standardized SOPs across customer service and returns, deploying a website AI chatbot to deflect routine FAQs. Connected WhatsApp for human escalation and Zendesk for ticket tracking, cutting manual handoffs and giving every query one clear path from first contact to resolution.

Projects (Github)

- Multi-Tier support pipeline
- Invoice exception Handler
- LLM Wikipedia (Rag System)
- Technical Integration Blueprint

Education & Certifications

- B.Sc. Business Administration, University of Lagos *(2016)*
- Introduction to Model Context Protocol *(Anthropic)*
- Introduction to Agent Skills *(Anthropic)*
- Deploy Multi-Agent Systems with Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform *(Google)*

Skillset

Technical Skills	Soft Skills
• LLM API integration • AI-native development • Prompt & context engineering • Agent evaluation & observability • RAG & knowledge retrieval systems • Process design & workflow automation	• Agile methodologies • Cross-functional collaboration • Clear technical communication • Systems thinking & execution • Fast iteration under ambiguity • Customer-first problem solving.

Additional Information

- **Interests**: Web3 & on-chain protocols, deep research, travel, customer obsessed
- **Languages**: English (proficient, native)
- **Tech Stack**: Python, Claude Code, Codex, Anthropic MCP, LangSmith, n8n, Zapier, GoHighLevel, Google Suite, Zendesk, Others*

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